

more favorable to the RIAA (Recording Industry Association of America) is the copy-protection part. Most DVD-Audio discs have copy protection that makes it harder if not impossible to copy music of the discs.

However, there is a downside to all of this. It is the price of DVD-Audio discs, which are pretty much on the higher side compared to a regular Audio CD. The other factor is the low penetration of DVD-Audio discs in the market since they are not compatible with the billion plus CD players around the planet. Unless, you have a player that specifies that it can play DVD-Audio, you cannot use a DVD-Audio disc.

To combat this, the DVD Forum has come out with another format called the DVDPlus or DualDisc format. This is a disc with two sides. DVDPlus/DualDisc offer either DVD-Video or DVD-Audio as well as CD content so it can include video, interactivity, stills and text as well as audio. Such types of discs are also called as Hybrid Discs.

Super Audio Compact Disc (SACD)

The SACD has been developed by the same two companies, which gave us the CD, Sony and Philips. While both these companies are also a part of the DVD Forum, they have gone ahead and brought out a product that directly competes with the DVD-Audio format.

The SACD utilizes a completely different way of encoding music on to a CD. While DVD-Audio discs use PCM (Pulse Code Modulation)/LPCM (Linear PCM) and MLP (Meridian Lossless Packaging) {PPCM- Packed PCM} techniques to contain music on a disc, SACD utilizes a technology called DSD (Direct Stream Digital) and DST (Direct Stream Transfer). Both these technologies are innovative but it is PCM, which represents music more truly than the SACD DSD technology. However, the bandwidth provided by these technologies for playing music is more than enough for pleasing any audiophile.